

AC Presents 2 New Pieces

Technical rider & CultureHub LA & September 16 to 25, 2026

SEPT 24 CONFIRMED · SEPT 19 PENDING

Two pieces to install in the room. Each has its own machines, signal plan, and system requirements.

Date	Event	Shape
Sat Sep 19, 2:00–3:30 p.m.	Grokaesthetic Workshop	Participatory; bring your own computer
Thu Sep 24, 7:00 p.m.	Piece 1 and Piece 2	Performance, conversation, free play

Thursday September 24 is confirmed. Saturday September 19 is still open: the guest set has been cut, and with it some of the case for two nights. This rider covers both; if they merge, the workshop’s requirements move to Thursday afternoon and nothing else changes.

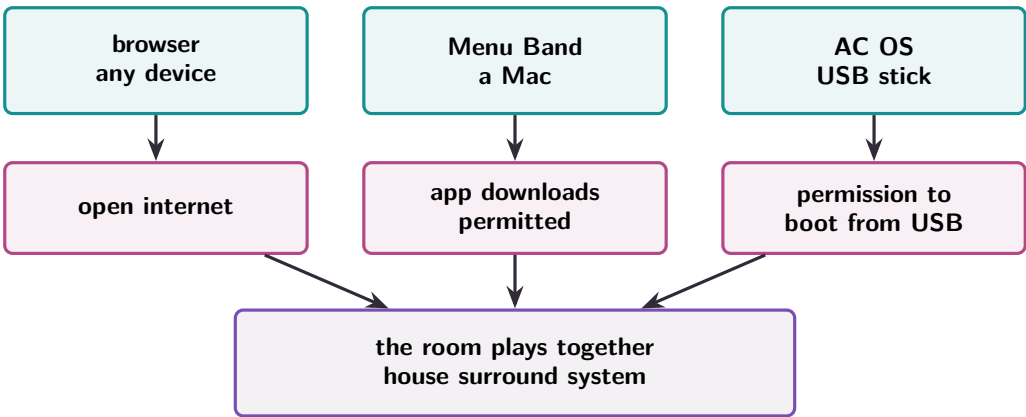
What gets installed

System	Machines	What the house provides
Workshop	Participant laptops and phones, plus loaners	Guest Wi-Fi for 25–35 devices with downloads permitted; participant power; stereo minimum
Piece 1 <i>Note(s)pat(ial) Native</i>	Six surplus laptops booted from AC OS USB drives	Six discrete inputs to the Kalio system; projection
Piece 2 <i>The MacNeoPolitan Trio</i>	Three MacBook Neos running Menu Band on macOS	Three discrete full-range positions; outbound NTP

Event one & Saturday

Grokaesthetic Workshop

Bring your own computer. Leave playing one.



Ninety minutes, hands-on, free and open to the public. Participants arrive with their own laptops and phones, get Aesthetic.Computer running on them, and the room finishes by playing together as one ensemble. The USB route installs nothing on a participant’s disk and alters nothing.

SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS

Network	Guest Wi-Fi for 25–35 simultaneous devices with app downloads permitted . The highest-risk item here: a captive portal or a download block turns the middle route off at the door.
Permissions	Participant laptops may be booted from USB in the space.
Power	Strips reaching the seating, enough for about 20 laptops. Assume nobody arrives charged.
Audio	Stereo playback minimum; the surround system preferred. Six-channel routing is welcome but not required.
Room	Tables or floor seating arranged so people can see each other rather than a stage, plus positions for the artist’s loaner machines. A microphone, or a room quiet enough to teach in.
Catering	A snack table with a nearby bin. A real requirement: the workshop is part hangout by design.

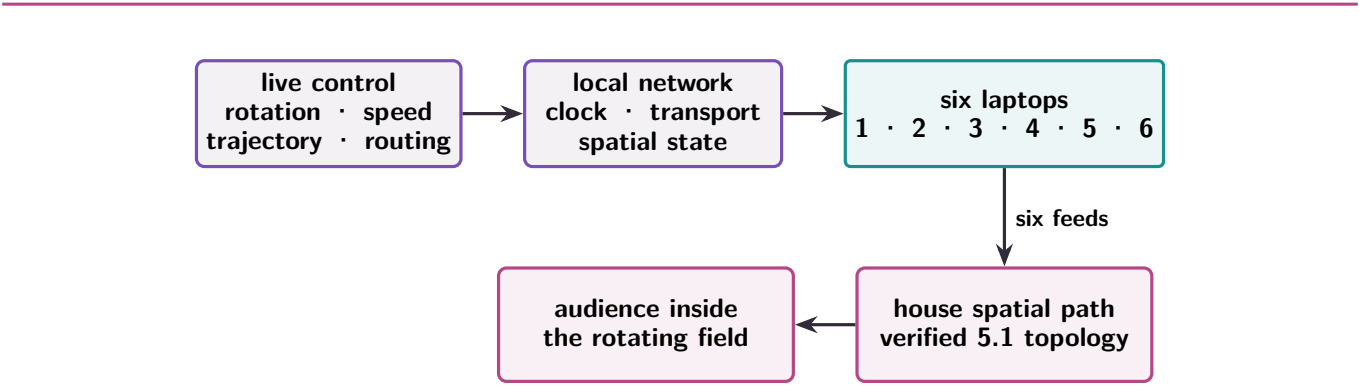
Access

No programming or musical experience is assumed, and loaner machines mean no one is turned away for lack of hardware. Please advise on accessible seating and whether the space suits participants who cannot sit on the floor.

Piece 1 & Thursday

Note(s)pat(ial) Native

Six laptops carry sound around the room while it turns.



Six surplus grade-school laptops, each booted from an AC OS USB drive, carry independent sound bodies around the audience. The artist drives rotation, trajectory, speed, and voice routing live from a control laptop, and the spatial score is projected while it plays.

SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS

Machines	Six surplus laptops booted from AC OS USB drives, plus one control laptop. Artist-supplied, with two spares.
Audio	Six discrete inputs to the Kalio 5.1 system, from an interface providing six line-level outputs, with DI boxes, cabling, and adapters to match.
Sixth channel	Bandwidth confirmed. If it is LFE-only, the field uses the five full-range channels and sends only derived low-frequency material to the LFE, or takes an additional full-range speaker if the venue supplies and approves one.
Network	Dedicated router or switch, isolated from public traffic, carrying clock, transport, and spatial control.
Power	Seven positions: six laptops and the control laptop.
Space	Six low tables or plinths arranged around the audience field, with the audience inside it.
Video	Projector, screen or projection wall, and an HDMI input near the performance position, for the live spatial score.
Will not run with	Routing hard-coded as six stationary voices. The piece performs spatial rotation by moving sound bodies across the available full-range outputs.

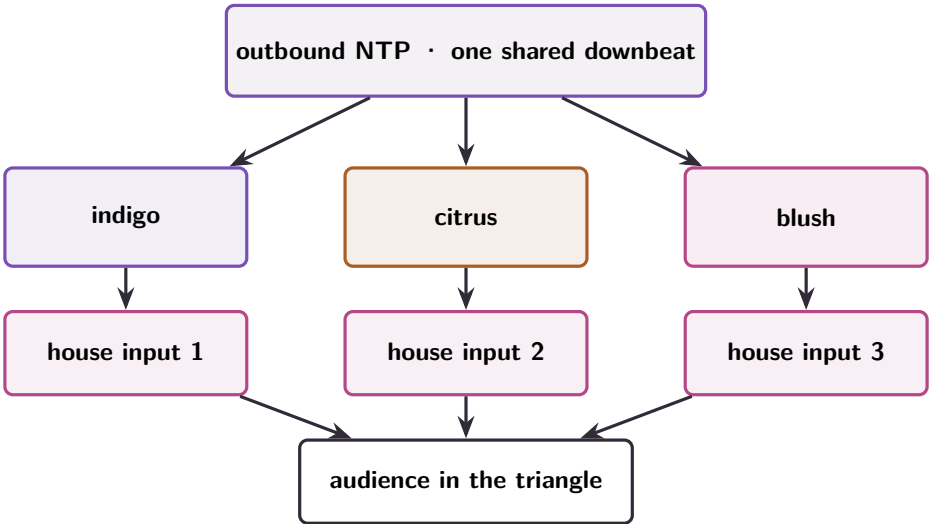
SIGNAL PLAN

Source	House destination
Laptops 1–5	Discrete full-range house inputs 1–5
Laptop 6	Full-range input 6 if available; otherwise a verified alternate route
Control laptop	Network control and projected score; no fixed audience-audio output
Documentation	Separate stereo fold-down, not the spatial performance bus

Piece 2 & Thursday

The MacNeoPolitan Trio

Three laptops, one downbeat, held by the clock rather than a cable.



Three MacBook Neos — indigo, citrus, and blush — each run Menu Band, the instrument that lives in the macOS menu bar, and each plays one voice of a trio. The piece runs from a `.mbscore`: a JSON score declaring three machines and one voice each; all three fire at a shared start epoch.

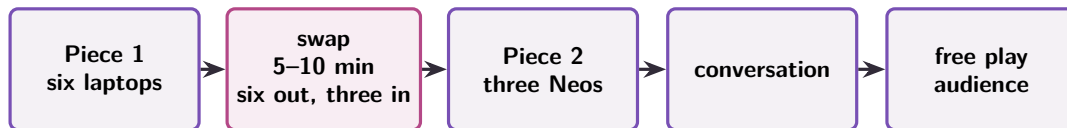
SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS

Machines	Three MacBook Neos running Menu Band on macOS. Artist-supplied, with the score pre-loaded.
Audio	Three discrete full-range positions forming a triangle around the audience, as wide as the room allows, and an interface taking three line-level feeds from the machines' own outputs: indigo, citrus, and blush to house inputs 1, 2, and 3.
Network	Outbound NTP must be reachable. The machines lock to one downbeat through synced wall clocks, typically tens of milliseconds across the fleet. There is no audio-clock link and no timecode between them, so a network that blocks NTP smears the downbeat.
Control	Whether local clients can reach each other over ssh on the house subnet. Conducting from one host uses ssh; if clients are isolated, the fallback is arming each machine locally, decided before the technical rehearsal rather than during it.
Power	Three positions.
Space	Three stable surfaces at the triangle points.
Does not use	USB boot. These machines run macOS from their own disks; AC OS is x86_64 UEFI only and will not boot on Apple silicon.

The evening

Running order & changeover & coda

The swap happens in front of the audience.



The move between the pieces is a hardware swap, not a patch change: six machines out, three in. The guest set that used to cover it has been cut, so it needs five to ten budgeted minutes and a decision about what the room does meanwhile — house lights and talking, a held drone from the outgoing machines, or the score on the projector. Please advise what CultureHub prefers.

Six line-level outputs cover both pieces if the patch can be changed during the swap. If it cannot, nine discrete paths are needed.

After the music there is a conversation, and then the instruments stay on for the audience to play, so the rig should not be struck until the room clears.

House request

The combined list

Audio and network

- Kalio 5.1 system with six independently addressable inputs; sixth-channel bandwidth confirmed.
- Interface or interfaces providing **six** line-level outputs, with the patch changed during the swap; **nine** if it cannot be changed.
- DI boxes, cabling, and adapters appropriate to the confirmed interfaces.
- Dedicated router or switch isolated from public traffic.
- **Outbound NTP reachable**, and confirmation of client-to-client ssh on the house subnet.
- **Guest Wi-Fi with internet access and app downloads permitted**, sized for 25–35 devices on the Saturday.

Power, room, projection

- **Nine** laptop power positions for the performance, one for the control laptop, conditioned power for audio and network gear, and **participant power strips for about 20 machines** on the Saturday.
- Six low tables or plinths around the audience field, plus **three stable surfaces** for the MacBook Neos.
- Projector, screen or projection wall, and an HDMI input near the performance position.
- Central seating for approximately 20–40 people, subject to room capacity.
- Snack table and bin for the workshop.
- Stereo livestream and documentation feed derived separately from the spatial mix.
- One technical rehearsal with CultureHub's audio and streaming staff, long enough to change the patch between the pieces and run both.

Jeffrey brings

- Six tested surplus laptops and two spares; six AC OS USB drives and two spares, plus workshop loaner sticks.
- Three MacBook Neos, each with Menu Band installed and the score pre-loaded.
- Loaner laptops for workshop participants without a machine.
- Power supplies for all nine performance machines, and the primary control laptop.
- Owned USB, HDMI, and network adapters; software images and offline recovery media.

Open questions

What CultureHub confirms & what the artist is carrying

Confirm with CultureHub

- Exact Kalio speaker layout, sixth-channel bandwidth, and whether the system accepts six discrete inputs or requires a house spatialization interface.
- Available interface channel count, connectors, and sample rate, and **whether the patch can be changed during the swap.**
- Wired network availability and house network policy — **outbound NTP, and client-to-client ssh.**
- **Whether guest Wi-Fi permits app downloads, and how many devices it holds.**
- **Whether participant laptops may be booted from USB in the space.**
- Projector resolution, throw, connectors, and screen location.
- Room dimensions, capacity, furniture, and accessible seating route.
- Livestream platform, capture format, archive ownership, and file delivery.
- Load-in, soundcheck, public-program, and strike hours, and how much changeover time is available.
- **Whether September 19 stays a separate event or folds into September 24.**

Risks the artist is carrying

- **The citrus machine is the working development Mac and has 8 GB of RAM,** documented as exhausting memory under load. A hang during Piece 2 stops one of three voices. Mitigation before load-in: perform from a clean boot with nothing else running, or swap in a fourth machine and keep citrus as the spare.
- **No spare third Neo yet.** The blush machine is unpurchased at the time of writing; until it exists there is no redundancy for the trio.
- **Clock drift is the silent failure.** Unlike a dropped cable, a smeared downbeat still plays and just sounds wrong. It gets verified at the technical rehearsal, on the room's actual network.
- **The workshop depends on someone else's network.** Two of the three ways in need working guest Wi-Fi and the third needs USB-boot permission. If all three are blocked the session degrades to the artist's loaner fleet. This is not fixable on the day.

